

1. Clifford Geertz: Symbolic Anthropology			2. Zora Neale Hurston			3. Sienna Craig: Kinship				
Symbolic Anthropology			Student of Franz Boas .			Focus:				
Culture = system of symbols and meanings in people’s minds .			Cultural Relativism				Nepalese diaspora			
Anthropologists must understand the insider/native perspective .			Cultures must be understood from:				marriage practices			
			→ insider perspective → not ethnocentrically.				kinship across distance.			
Deep Play			Mules and Men			Marriage Types				
Term from Jeremy Bentham .			Ethnography of Eatonville, Florida .				Arranged marriage			
Definition: Activities with irrationally high stakes .			Documented:				Love marriage			
Example:	Balinese Cockfight			folklore		Polygamy	multiple spouses			
				jokes			one man + multiple women			
				everyday life			one woman + multiple men			
Geertz’s argument:		speech dialect.		Polyandry						
→ betting not based on rooster ability		Controversy:			Example:					
→ reflects kinship alliances and rivalries					Fraternal polyandry					
People bet on rooster owned by their kin			Some Harlem Renaissance critics believed she portrayed Black life				brothers share one wife			
Function: reinforces social relationships							preserves family property.			
Example analogy:			Importance:			Residence Patterns				
	→ F1 fans supporting Ferrari					recorded authentic speech and cultural life .		Patrilocal	living with husband’s family.	
	→ Football fans supporting losing teams.								Matrilocal	living with wife’s family.
						Neolocal	living independently			
4. Marshall Sahlins: Mutuality of Being			5. Gramsci: Cultural Hegemony				6. Althusser: Ideological State Apparatus			
Definition:			Question:			State power reproduced through institutions .				
	Kinship involves people who share each other’s			How do states maintain power without constant violence?		Examples:				
	Key idea:									
	Kinship is not just biological.		Cultural Hegemony				schools			
	Ruling class maintains power by spreading ideas that justify their rule .			media						
Kin share:			Spread through:				churches			
	experiences			schools			family			
	emotions			media		unions.				
	suffering and joy.			religion		These institutions spread ideology.				
Examples:			culture.			Result:				
	chosen kin					people internalize social system values .				
	close friends acting as family									
17. Foucault: Discipline vs Sovereign Power			Example:			Example:				
Sovereign Power (pre-modern)				Standard language ideology			Japanese Obento lunches			
Power through visible punishment and violence .				Belief that some ways of speaking are “correct”.			mothers feel obligated to create elaborate lunches			
Examples:			This legitimizes elite power.				defines “good motherhood”.			
			Important:			16. Ideology				
	torture			Hegemony is contestable .						
	public executions.			Definition:						
Purpose:			System of beliefs and ideas that justify or maintain social power structures .				schools			
	display authority of rulers.		Connected to:				media			
							religion			
							culture.			
			Gramsci	cultural hegemony		Example:				
			Althusser	ideological state apparatus						
						Standard language ideology.				

7. Foucault: Discipline			8. Timothy Mitchell: Fetishism of the State			9. Edward Said: Orientalism				
Power is not only top-down.			Common belief:			Orient				
Power is diffuse and operates through self-discipline .				The state is a separate entity acting on society .		Historical Western term for:				
People regulate themselves.			Mitchell’s argument:				Middle East			
Panopticon			The state is constructed through practices and perceptions .			Orientalism				
Prison structure with central surveillance tower .						Western system of knowledge that stereotypes the East .				
Because prisoners might be watched:			Ways to study the state:			Constructs East as:				
	they behave as if they are always watched.						irrational			
Modern disciplinary institutions:						Representation			chaotic	
						what the state says it does			sensual	
						Practices			exotic.	
						what the state actually does		Purpose:		
			Effects			Define the West as:				
	prisons		Examples:					rational		
	schools							civilized		
	hospitals							superior.		
	workplaces.									
10. Standard Language Ideology			11. Key Comparison: Theories of Power			12. Core Anthropological Concepts				
Belief:			Gramsci			Cultural Relativism				
There’s a correct way to speak .			Power through ideas and ideology .			Understand cultures from their own perspective .				
Effects:			Althusser			Ethnocentrism				
	privileges elite speech		Power through institutions (ISA) .			Judging other cultures by one’s own cultural standards .				
	marginalizes dialects		Foucault							
	reinforces social hierarchy.		Power through discipline and self-regulation .							
Example:			Power becomes increasingly internalized by individuals							
	“educated speech” vs “improper speech”.									
13. Clifford Geertz: Thick Description			14. Emic vs Etic			15. Participant Observation				
Definition:			Emic (insider perspective)			Primary anthropological research method.				
Detailed explanation of behavior + its cultural meaning and context .			Understanding culture from the viewpoint of participants .			Definition:				
Goal:			Examples:			Researcher participates in daily life while observing social behavior .				
Interpret symbols and meanings , not just actions.				local meanings		Methods include:				
Example:				beliefs			observation			
Eye twitch	biological movement		Etic (outsider perspective)				interviews			
Wink:	social signal with cultural meaning		Analytical interpretation by researchers				field notes			
Purpose: Reveal how people understand their own actions .			Examples:				long-term immersion.			
				comparative analysis		Goal:				
				theoretical explanations.			Understand culture from inside the community .			
			Anthro often combines emic + etic .							
						Used by:				
							Hurston			
							Geertz			